

PROJECT PROPOSAL RUBRIC

Score the student's question, hypothesis, and experimental design before data collection begins. A score of 2 or lower on any row means the design needs revision before the student starts.

USE AT WEEKS 2 TO 6, DEPENDING ON GRADE BAND

CRITERION	4 EXCEEDS	3 MEETS	2 APPROACHING	1 BEGINNING
Research question	Question is testable, specific, and connects to a real-world problem the student can name.	Question is testable and specific.	Question is on topic but too broad or hard to test as written.	Question is missing, not testable, or copied without understanding.
Hypothesis	Clear if, then, because statement with sound scientific reasoning behind the prediction.	Clear if, then, because statement with a stated reason.	Prediction is present but vague, or the reasoning is missing.	No prediction, or the statement cannot be tested.
Variables identified	Independent, dependent, and controlled variables are all named correctly and completely.	All three variable types are named correctly.	Independent and dependent are named; controlled variables are incomplete.	Variables are missing or confused with one another.
Procedure	Steps are numbered, precise, and detailed enough that another student could repeat the work exactly.	Steps are numbered and a reader could follow them.	Steps are present but skip detail a reader would need.	Procedure is missing or too vague to follow.
Trials and controls	Plans three or more trials and includes a control group with a clear rationale.	Plans three or more trials and includes a control group.	Plans fewer than three trials, or the control group is unclear.	No trial plan and no control group.
Safety and feasibility	Materials are listed, safety is addressed, and any approval needed is already scheduled.	Materials are listed and safety is addressed.	Materials list is incomplete or safety is not addressed.	Project is unsafe or cannot be completed with available time and materials.

SCORE

Total out of 24: _____ Student: _____ Date: _____

FEEDBACK FOR THE STUDENT
